

Bayesian Optimization of Multi-Material 3D-Printed Tensegrity-Inspired Structures for Energy Absorption

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Tensegrity-inspired architectures combine rigid compression members with a continuous network of soft tension elements, yielding lightweight assemblies with tunable nonlinear responses that are attractive for energy-absorbing applications such as protective equipment, packaging, and aerospace landing structures. Multi-material fused-deposition modeling (FDM) of polylactic acid (PLA) struts and thermoplastic polyurethane (TPU) tension elements makes it possible to fabricate diverse tensegrity-inspired geometries rapidly enough to support a high-throughput experimental search, while the rate-dependent damping of TPU is itself an asset for impact mitigation. We report an experiment-driven Bayesian optimization (BO) framework in which a Gaussian-process surrogate is trained directly on physical quasi-static compression and drop-weight impact data and used to recommend the next batch of designs to print and test. The framework parameterizes a family of tensegrity-inspired unit cells over strut geometry, tension-element cross-section, connectivity topology, and unit-cell tiling, and optimizes peak transmitted force, specific energy absorption, and compaction efficiency.

Tighten abstract to 150–200 words with concrete numerical results once the experimental campaign is complete.

Keywords: tensegrity, multi-material 3D printing, Bayesian optimization, energy absorption, design of experiments

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Author order / contributions (per @me-madsen). Planned order: Marcus E. Madsen*, Audrey K. Christiansen*, Jinkwan Han*, Jeffrey R. Hill†‡, Sterling G. Baird†‡, where * = equal contribution, † = also equal contribution, and ‡ = corresponding author. Confirm affiliations and add emails for M. Madsen, A. Christiansen, and J. Han, and typeset the equal-contribution footnote per ASME JMD style.

1 Introduction

Manuscript status. At time of writing the project is at the *planned-methods* phase: the parameterized unit cell, multi-material print recipe, joint geometry, quasi-static and drop-impact protocols, and Bayesian-optimization loop described in Section 3 have been scaffolded and prototype hardware has been printed, but the closed-loop experimental campaign has not yet produced reportable results. Sections 4 and 5 therefore remain placeholders.

Tensegrity structures are assemblies of rigid compression members suspended within a continuous network of tension members; their defining property, that no two rigid bars touch, yields lightweight assemblies with remarkable strength-to-weight ratios and tunable nonlinear mechanical responses [1,2]. These properties have made tensegrity attractive across scales, from metamaterial unit cells [3–5] to compliant impact-absorbing robots developed for planetary landing [6–10]. Recent work has shown that *tensegrity-inspired* unit cells can be directly 3D-printed and exhibit load-limiting plateaus under drop-weight impact [11], opening a path toward additively manufactured architected absorbers. Throughout, we use *tensegrity-inspired* to denote printable unit cells that adopt the characteristic tensegrity motif—rigid compression members carried by a network of pretensioned soft tension elements—while relaxing the strict classical requirement that no two compression members touch and that the tension members behave as ideal inextensible cables; here the tension elements are

extruded TPU and the struts may share printed junctions.

Multi-material fused-deposition modeling (FDM) that pairs a rigid polymer such as polylactic acid (PLA) with a soft, rate-dependent elastomer such as thermoplastic polyurethane (TPU) has been used to fabricate rigid–soft architected energy absorbers on a single platform—for example, thick-panel origami metamaterials with PLA panels and TPU hinges [12] and ABS/TPU honeycombs with tunable stiff/flexible proportions [13]. The same rigid–soft co-printing capability makes it possible to rapidly fabricate diverse tensegrity-inspired geometries, which adopt a discrete-compression/continuous-tension topology rather than an origami or honeycomb one. Although extruded TPU does not behave as an idealized inextensible cable, its rate-dependent damping is a desirable property for impact-absorption applications and complements the elastic stiffness of the PLA compression members rather than competing with it.

Designing such architected absorbers is fundamentally a *design-of-experiments* problem: the configuration space spanned by strut geometry, tension-element cross-section, connectivity, and unit-cell tiling is large; each candidate must be physically printed and tested; and the relevant performance metrics—peak transmitted force, specific energy absorption (SEA), and compaction efficiency—are noisy and partially correlated. Bayesian optimization (BO) is well-matched to this regime, having driven breakthroughs from hyperparameter tuning of AlphaGo [14] to sustainable concrete [15], autonomous discovery of organic laser emitters [16], and architected materials [17–20].

1.0.1 Contributions. This paper makes the following contributions:

- (1) A parameterized family of multi-material 3D-printable tensegrity-inspired unit cells with PLA compression members and TPU tension elements that are anchored *inside* the

Add 1–2 sentences clearly stating the gap this paper closes vs. Pajunen et al. [11] (single fabrication condition, no closed-loop optimization) and Mo et al. [17] (multifidelity BO, but simulation-only)

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ends of each PLA strut—the strut acting as a rigid cage in which the cables meeting at a given end join before exiting through discrete outlets—to ensure cyclic interface durability.

(2) An experiment-driven BO loop, built on BoTorch/Ax [21,22], that operates directly on physical quasi-static compression and drop-weight impact measurements, recommending the next designs to fabricate.

We need to decide whether or not to mention/include the physics-based simulations from PR #33, which seem quite reasonable at this point. If the goal is to get the best of the best, then we would want to include those simulations. In that case we would likely want to treat this as a multi-task problem, but we could run into issues with scaling. If we treat it as a featurization task, then we would likely need to move to a predefined search space or a genetic algorithm.

(3) High-fidelity validation experiments using *pretensioned* tensegrity assemblies (true cables and measured pretension) for the Pareto-optimal designs identified by the single-stage loop above, reported separately rather than fused into the optimization.

The remainder of the paper is organized as follows. Section 2 reviews tensegrity mechanics, multi-material 3D printing for energy absorption, and Bayesian optimization with an emphasis on multi-objective and noise-robust acquisition functions. Section 3 introduces the design parameterization, fabrication workflow, experimental protocols, and BO loop. Section 4 reports the results of the closed-loop experimental campaign, and Section 5 discusses the implications and limitations of the approach. Section 6 concludes.

2 Background

2.1 Tensegrity-Inspired Architectures for Energy Absorption. Tensegrity prisms and their planar extensions exhibit softening–stiffening response under compression [3–5], characteristics desirable for impact mitigation because the structure can absorb a large fraction of the input energy at a controlled, sub-injurious force plateau. Santos [23] recently characterized a tensegrity energy-dissipation metamaterial reporting equivalent viscous damping on the order of ~23% with negligible residual strain per impact, underscoring the suitability of tensegrity-inspired architectures for repeated-impact use cases. The space program literature documents large-scale tensegrity-inspired absorbers for planetary landing [6–10] and a long history of crushable energy-absorbing landing systems [24–26]. Pajunen et al. [11] demonstrated that truncated-tetrahedral tensegrity-inspired unit cells can be directly 3D-printed and exhibit load-limiting plateaus, motivating the present focus on additively manufactured TPU/PLA composites. More recent work on dynamically loaded additively-manufactured energy-absorbing lattices [27], together with Intrigila et al.’s bistable tensegrity-like unit cell for lattice metamaterials [28] as the closest published analog, confirms that this architecture class also responds favorably under impact and quasi-static loading, although neither study employed multi-material FFF or closed-loop design optimization.

2.2 Multi-Material 3D Printing of PLA/TPU Composites. Multi-material rigid–soft FDM enables stiff/compliant combinations on a single platform with tunable energy absorption, demonstrated for thick-panel origami with PLA (or ABS/CFRP) panels and TPU hinges [12] and for ABS–TPU honeycombs [13]. Neither study is itself a tensegrity, but both establish the rigid–soft co-printing route we adopt. Ye et al. [12] introduced a *wrapping-based* strategy in which rigid cores are encapsulated by continuous soft skins, preventing interface delamination and enabling cyclic durability, something we take inspiration from in our designs. Recent multi-material PLA/TPU sandwich and layered composites [29,30] report quantitative bounds on stiffness, strength, and energy absorption for the same PLA–TPU pair used here, while fused filament fabrication (FFF) PLA fatigue data [31,32] inform conservative design bounds for the rigid struts. Architected multi-material

lattices with co-printed compliant skins have been explicitly designed for high specific energy absorption [33], with FFF-specific multimaterial interface adhesion (notably TPU bonded to rigid co-printed substrates) characterized in [34]; recent surveys catalogue the rapidly expanding additively manufactured polymeric energy-absorption literature [35,36].

2.3 Bayesian Optimization for Architected-Material Design. Bayesian optimization is a sequential, model-based strategy for optimizing expensive black-box functions using a Gaussian-process surrogate [37,38]. Modern implementations such as BoTorch [21] and the Ax platform built atop it [22] support parallel batched evaluations and a wide variety of acquisition functions; recent algorithmic advances include log-EI for numerical robustness [39], noisy expected hypervolume improvement for multi-objective settings [40], input-noise-robust acquisitions [41], and evolution-guided constrained multi-objective BO for self-driving labs [42]. Mixed/categorical search spaces—needed here for the discrete connectivity-topology variable—have dedicated treatments in BOCS [43] and the one-hot-with-rounded-kernel construction of [44]. BO has been applied to mechanical metamaterial and structural design [17–19] and to additive manufacturing [20]. Mo et al. [17] in particular established a multifidelity BO framework for architected materials by fusing low-fidelity simulations with high-fidelity ground truth via nonlinear information-fusion priors [45]; the present work shifts the emphasis from simulation surrogates to direct experimental data, appropriate for materials whose constitutive response is difficult to calibrate from first principles.

3 Materials and Methods

3.1 Design Parameterization. We parameterize a family of tensegrity-inspired unit cells via four groups of design variables:

- **PLA compression members.** Strut diameter d_s and length ℓ_s , with the slenderness ratio ℓ_s/d_s bounded away from buckling-dominated regimes.
- **TPU tension elements.** Cross-sectional area A_t (or equivalent diameter d_t for circular cross-sections) and pre-tension geometry imposed during printing.
- **Connectivity topology.** Selected from a discrete set of candidate unit cells (e.g., truncated-tetrahedral, prism-based, and octahedral variants); the design vector encodes a categorical choice.
- **Unit-cell tiling.** Number of cells $N_x \times N_y \times N_z$ and the orientation of each cell relative to the impact direction.

3.1.1 Working prototype. The first instance of this family used to validate the fabrication and test pipeline is a three-strut (T_3) tensegrity prism scaled to a ~50mm bounding box, with $d_s =$ and a cable diameter d_t swept over the FFF-resolvable set {1.2, 1.8, 2.4, 3.0, 4.5} mm. Under the prism’s D_3 symmetry the twelve member-diameter axes collapse to four orbit axes (one strut orbit and three cable orbits: saddle, top, bottom), which keeps the initial design vector low-dimensional while leaving room to relax to per-member diameters once the saddle/top/bottom orbits have been individually characterized. Figure 2 shows the parametric CAD model alongside an as-printed prototype of this working T_3 prism.

3.2 Multi-Material Fabrication. Specimens are fabricated on a multi-material FDM printer using PLA for the rigid struts and TPU for the soft tension elements. Figure 3 summarizes the end-to-end fabrication and characterization workflow, from parametric CAD through multi-material slicing, dual-extrusion printing, post-processing, and mechanical testing. Rather than wrapping the struts in a continuous TPU skin, the current design anchors the TPU tension elements *inside* the ends of each PLA strut: the cables

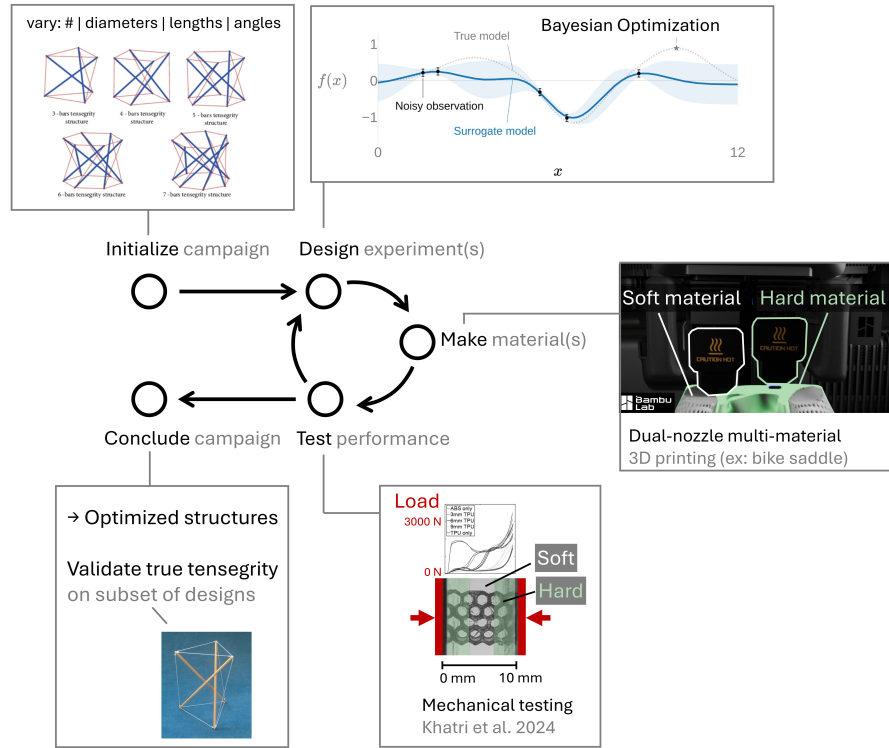


Fig. 1 Closed-loop, experiment-driven design framework. Parameterized PLA/TPU tensegrity-inspired unit cells are printed, tested under quasi-static compression and drop-weight impact, and the resulting performance data drive a Gaussian-process surrogate that recommends the next batch of designs to fabricate.

Table 1 Design variables for the T_3 -prism Sobol initialization batch, as implemented in the BO harness (single-iteration $n = 9$ Sobol set). The joint diameter is held fixed at the t3-prism.scad default; all specimens are printed in the vertical orientation and packed 3×3 on a single Bambu Lab H2D plate.

Design variable	Symbol	Units	Range
Base radius	R	mm	25–40
Cell height	H	mm	60–110
Twist angle	θ	deg	40–80
Strut (PLA) diameter	d_s	mm	6.0–12.0
Cable (TPU) diameter	d_t	mm	3.0–5.5
Joint diameter (fixed)	d_j	mm	7.0

converging at a given strut end are joined within the strut, which acts as a rigid cage housing the junction, and the individual tendons then exit through discrete outlets. This keeps the soft-rigid interface in internal, compression-dominated pockets rather than at an exposed overmolded surface. This construction effectively inverts the material roles of Ye et al.’s soft-skin-over-rigid-core wrapping [12]: here a soft TPU core is captured within a rigid PLA shell, so we cite that work only as a multi-material co-printing precedent rather than as validation of the present junction.

3.2.1 Print platform and joint geometry. The working platform is a Bambu Lab H2D printer, which permits a single rigid-soft build without filament swaps. Strut endpoints are tied to cables through parametric joint geometries developed and ranked through a five-design OpenSCAD study (anchor-bulb, dovetail, TPU-sleeve overmold, eyelet-loop, and TPU-rebar variants); the working prototype uses a dovetail joint (Design B) with an anchor-bulb backup (Design A) for sensitivity studies, with a captive TPU core routed

inside the PLA shell to keep the soft tendon protected from layer-line failure at the strut-to-cable transition. The full five-design comparison and the selected junction are detailed in the Supplementary Information.

3.2.2 Supports for soft members. Because near-vertical TPU tendons are otherwise unsupported during printing, the slicer profile combines a tensegrity-specific Bambu Studio recipe (support threshold angle dropped from 40° to 10° , support material matched to the rigid extruder) with manually generated narrowing pillars that ray-cast against the printable mesh underside, producing TPU-safe coverage of vertical members without slicer-side painting. Full workflow details are provided in the Supplementary Information.

Table 2 Multi-material print parameters on the Bambu Lab H2D. Cells marked *TBD* are pending confirmation; the reporting structure follows the methods section of Ye et al. [12].

Parameter	PLA (rigid struts)	TPU (soft tendons)
Nozzle temperature ($^\circ\text{C}$)	<i>TBD</i>	<i>TBD</i>
Bed temperature ($^\circ\text{C}$)		<i>TBD</i>
Layer height (mm)		<i>TBD</i>
Print speed (mm/min)	<i>TBD</i>	<i>TBD</i>
Infill (%)	<i>TBD</i>	<i>TBD</i>
Build-plate type	Textured PEI	
Build orientation	Vertical	
Supports	Off in slicer; manual narrowing pillars	

3.3 Experimental Characterization. Each printed specimen is subjected to two physical tests:

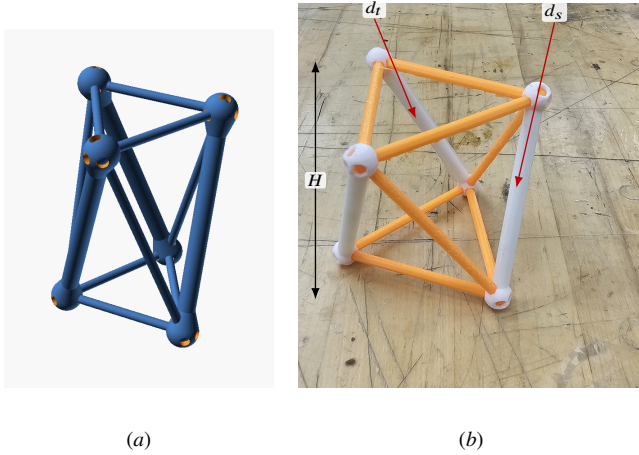


Fig. 2 Working T_3 -prism prototype. (a) Parametric OpenSCAD model whose base radius R , cell height H , twist angle θ , strut diameter d_s , and cable diameter d_t are the design variables of Table 1. (b) A representative dual-material print from the PR #35 print history (rigid PLA struts, here in white; tendon members in orange), with callouts marking the strut diameter d_s , a tendon (cable) diameter d_t , and the cell height H ; the inter-plate twist θ is the relative rotation of the top and bottom node triangles, and the base radius R sets their circumradius.

3.3.1 Quasi-static compression. A uniaxial load-displacement curve is recorded on a benchtop electromechanical load frame (BYU CB 123 Instron) following best-practice combinations of ASTM D638, ASTM D412, ASTM E111, ASTM F2971, and ISO/ASTM 52900/52921 adapted to architected polymer cells. Because expected cell stiffnesses fall in the ~ 5 – 30 g force range, the default 5 kN load cell is over-ranged and is being replaced by a 100–500 N cell for the first campaign. Reported metrics are

$$\text{SEA} = \frac{1}{m} \int_0^{\delta_d} F(\delta) d\delta, \quad \eta_c = \frac{\int_0^{\delta_d} F(\delta) d\delta}{F_{\max} \delta_d}, \quad (1)$$

where m is the specimen mass, δ_d is the densification displacement, $F_{\max}$ is the peak transmitted force, and η_c is the compaction efficiency. To keep these metrics objective and reproducible, the densification displacement δ_d is taken as the displacement at which the energy-absorption efficiency–displacement curve reaches its maximum ($d\eta/d\delta = 0$), and $F_{\max}$ is the maximum force recorded within the integration window $[0, \delta_d]$ rather than a global or post-densification peak.

3.3.2 Drop-weight impact. Following Pajunen et al. [11], specimens are subjected to drop-weight impact tests with instrumented load cells; we report the peak transmitted force and the energy-absorption plateau characteristics. Figure 4 illustrates the mechanism-oriented presentation we adopt for these processed deceleration traces, linking features of the measured signal to the structural events that produce them. The primary fixture is a bungee-assisted laboratory drop tower in which the base accelerates downward faster than $1g$; because unconstrained specimens lift off the base during descent by design of the rig, the protocol constrains the specimen top through light tethers (capping upward travel) and registers the base via transfer tape or V-block features so that loading-direction compliance is not altered. A higher-fidelity replicate campaign on a Lansmont M23 shock/cushion tester (per ASTM D1596) with synchronized Polytec QTEC laser vibrometry is planned for selected Pareto-optimal designs. Slip resistance and traction at the specimen–floor interface—governed by the tip geometry rather than the internal lattice—follow the test methodology

of ISO 11334-4 [46] for walking-aid tips and are out of scope for the present axial-impact study.

3.3.3 Per-modality objectives. Five complementary data streams (triaxial accelerometer, high-speed video, shaker transfer function, slug-firing gas gun, and Polytec QTEC laser-Doppler vibrometer) each contribute a distinct raw observable; the mapping from each stream to BO-ready scalar objectives (SEA, VEA, $F_{\max}$, cushion-curve intercept, Gibson–Ashby relative density) is defined in five companion briefs and consolidated in a cross-modality synthesis.

3.4 Experiment-Driven Bayesian Optimization Loop. The optimization loop maintains a Gaussian-process (GP) surrogate over the design space defined in Section 3.1. After each round of physical experiments, the GP is updated and an acquisition function is maximized to recommend the next batch of designs to fabricate. Implementation uses BoTorch [21] with the log-Expected-Improvement (LogEI) acquisition [39] for the single-objective baseline and noisy Expected Hypervolume Improvement (qNEHVI) [40] for the multi-objective case (simultaneously maximizing SEA and compaction efficiency while constraining peak transmitted force). When experimental noise dominates (e.g., between-print variability), we additionally evaluate the input-noise-robust acquisition of Daulton et al. [41] and the evolution-guided constrained variant of Low et al. [42]. The discrete connectivity-topology variable is handled with the mixed-search-space construction of [44]; the BOCS combinatorial baseline [43] is reported for comparison.

3.4.1 Implementation status. The campaign harness is built on Ax’s HierarchicalSearchSpace so that printer-feasibility constraints (e.g. the cable-diameter categorical depending on the chosen connectivity topology) can be encoded directly in the search space rather than enforced post hoc. The first physical batch consists of $n = 9$ specimens generated by a Sobol sequence over the four D_3 -orbit axes of the working T_3 prism and printed in a single 3×3 plate layout. For the present ≤ 25 -dimensional parameterization the default acquisition pairing is sparse axis-aligned subspace BO (SAASBO) with qNEHVI; escalation to trust-region BO (TuRBO) is planned only if larger per-member-diameter tilings push the design space well beyond this regime.

Once the campaign produces model data, the fitted surrogate is audited with the leave-one-out cross-validation and parameter-sensitivity diagnostics of Figs. 5 and 6.

The previous BO-loop schematic here was redundant with the overview figure (Fig. 1); per review it is replaced with surrogate-diagnostic figures. Figs. 5–8 are currently illustrative examples produced by a real Ax/BoTorch loop on synthetic objective values (scripts/figures/ax_placeholder_figures_example.py); replace the synthetic evaluate() with measured outcomes once the campaign runs.

4 Results

Populate Results section once the experimental campaign produces data. Suggested subsections follow.

4.1 Convergence of the BO Loop. Figure 7 illustrates the intended convergence comparison.

4.2 Pareto-Optimal Designs. Figure 8 shows the form the Pareto-front presentation will take.

4.3 Reproducibility Across Print Replicates.

Table repeatability: Mean and CV of SEA, peak force, and compaction efficiency across n replicate prints for the top- k designs.

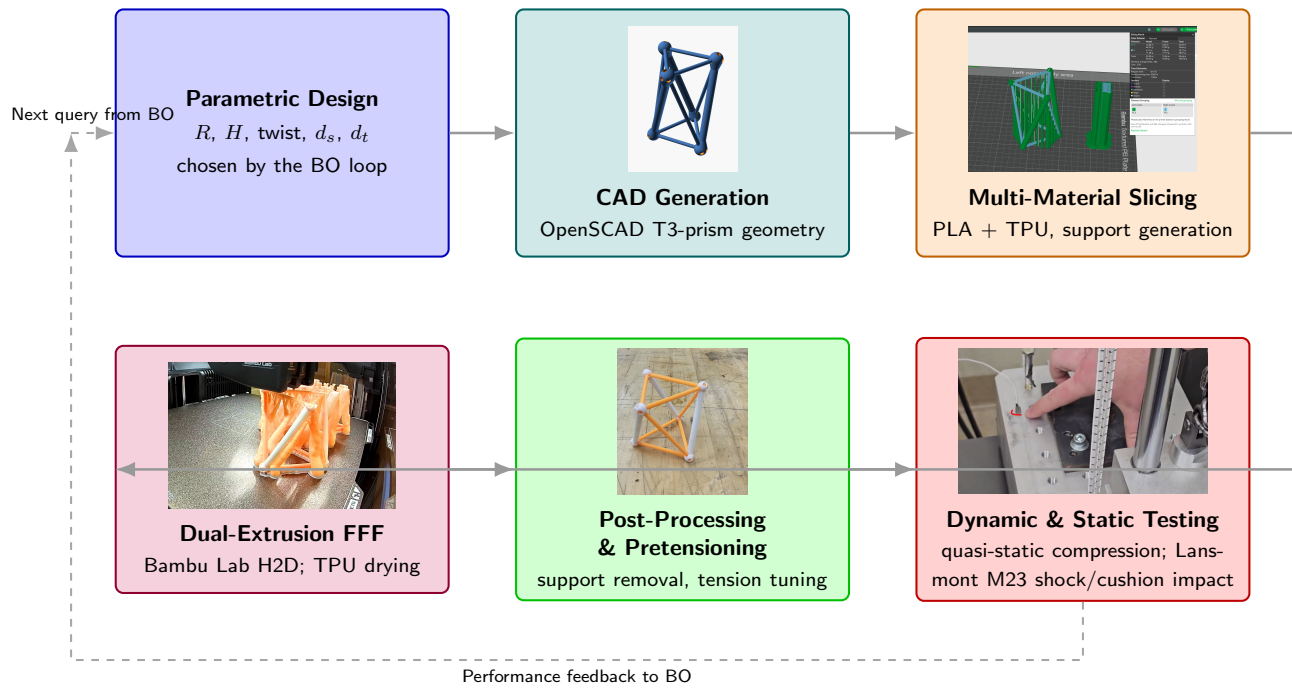


Fig. 3 Fabrication and characterization workflow for the multi-material tensegrity-inspired unit cells: design parameters drive parametric CAD, slicing with manually generated TPU supports, a single multi-material print on the Bambu Lab H2D, post-processing and inspection, and mechanical testing. Node photographs are representative artifacts drawn from the project's build history: the OpenSCAD T_3 -prism render (CAD), the dual-nozzle Bambu Studio slice with PLA on the left extruder and TPU on the right (slicing), an in-progress H2D print of the prism batch (FFF), an as-printed specimen (post-processing), and the bungee-assisted drop-tower base plate with accelerometer (testing).

Table 3 Placeholder. Mean and CV of SEA, peak force, and compaction efficiency across n replicate prints for the top- k designs.

Column A	Column B	Column C
(table contents pending)		

5 Discussion

Populate Discussion section once Results are in. Anchor against the gaps identified in Section 1 and the prior work cited in Section 2.

Topics to address:

- Comparison to the simulation-driven multifidelity framework of Mo et al. [17] and the single-condition fabrication study of Pajunen et al. [11].
- Practical considerations: TPU-PLA interface durability under cyclic loading; sensitivity of optimal designs to print parameters (extrusion temperature, layer height); transferability to TPU/PETG or other high-temperature thermoplastics.
- Path forward toward integrated tread+latice structures, miniaturization to crutch-tip envelopes (from the Edison crutch-tip synthesis), and field testing. Long-term crutch use is associated with substantial upper-extremity overuse injury and ground-reaction-force impulses [47–51]; existing spring-loaded [52,53] and polymer-damped [54] tip designs reduce loading rate but not peak transmitted force, leaving an open design opportunity that an architected tensegrity-inspired insert is well-positioned to address. Recent open-source 3D-printed crutch work [55] and expert evaluations of orthopaedic caps [56] suggest a plausible translation path; adjacent footwear and orthotic lattice studies [57–59] provide additional transferable design heuristics.

5.0.1 Limitations..

6 Conclusions

We have presented an experiment-driven Bayesian-optimization framework for designing multi-material 3D-printed tensegrity-inspired energy absorbers using PLA struts and TPU tension elements. The framework parameterizes a family of unit cells, fabricates each candidate on a single multi-material FDM platform with TPU tendons anchored inside the PLA strut ends, characterizes the response under quasi-static compression and drop-weight impact, and updates a Gaussian-process surrogate [21] that recommends the next batch of designs. The approach is broadly applicable to architected absorbers whose constitutive response is difficult to calibrate from first principles and where physical experiments—rather than simulations—are the natural ground truth.

Acknowledgment

This work was supported by the Brigham Young University Mentored Research Grant program. The authors thank the undergraduate researchers who carried out the multi-material printing and impact testing, and the graduate co-mentor who supported day-to-day operations.

Funding Data

- Brigham Young University Mentored Research Grant ().

Conflict of Interest

The authors declare no conflict of interest.

Identify limitations: design space size relative to experimental budget; reliance on a single fabrication platform; metric selection (axial impact only).

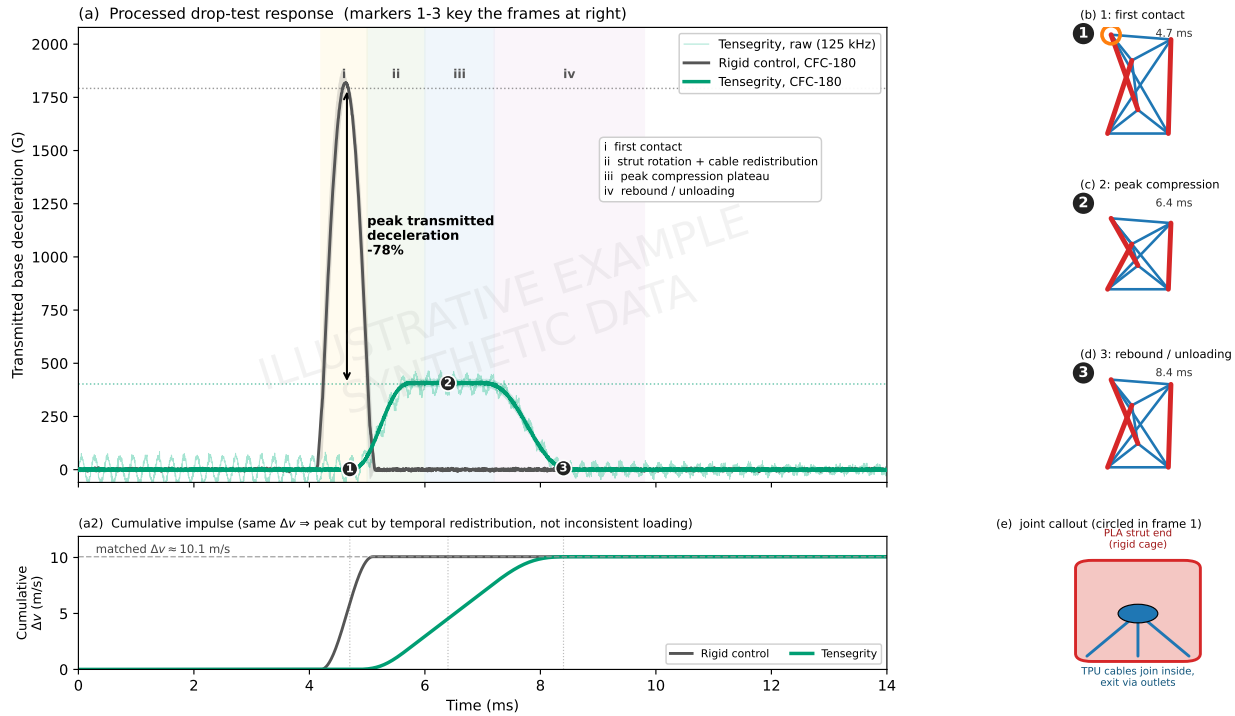
Two-sentence quantitative summary of the headline outcome (e.g., improvement in SEA over baselines within N rounds; identification of a Pareto-optimal geometry validated by replicate prints).

Confirm exact grant numbers and acknowledge any NASA/Utah Space-Grant Consortium support per acknowledgment text guidelines.

award number

Add Utah NASA Space Grant Consortium award if applicable.

EXAMPLE (mock-up, synthetic data): mechanism-oriented drop-test figure



Synthetic illustration. In a real figure: transmitted base deceleration of a rigid control vs. T3-prism tensegrity, both SAE J211 CFC-180 filtered (125 kHz raw shown faint), zero-phase (filtfilt), time-aligned on the CH4 first-contact index. Curves are the mean of $n=5$ replicates; bands are ± 1 s.d. Frames 1-3 are high-speed/DIC stills at markers 1-3; (e) shows the internal cable-anchor joint that spreads the impulse.

Fig. 4 Illustrative example (synthetic data). Template for the mechanism-oriented drop-test figures planned for the Results: (a) processed deceleration response of a rigid control vs. a tensegrity specimen (SAE J211 CFC-180 filtered), with event-based phase shading and numbered markers keyed to the schematic frames (b)–(d); (a2) cumulative-impulse subpanel showing the two traces transfer the same mass-normalized Δv , so the lower tensegrity peak reflects temporal redistribution rather than inconsistent loading; (e) the internal-anchor joint load path. Curves are synthetic and impulse-consistent (control anchored to the documented ~ 1792 G CFC-180 peak; tensegrity shoulder scaled to the same impulse), pending real high-rate channels and camera frames. Generated by scripts/figures/mechanistic_data_figure_example.py.

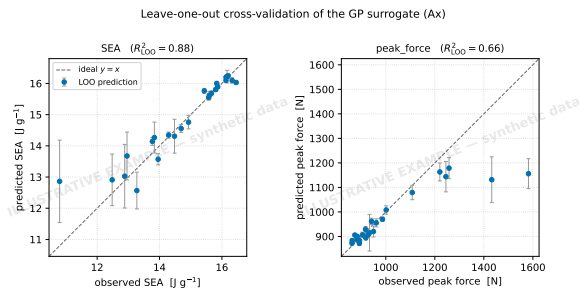


Fig. 5 Illustrative example (synthetic data). Leave-one-out cross-validation of the Gaussian-process surrogate—predicted vs. observed specific energy absorption (SEA) and peak transmitted force, with model error bars and R^2_{LOO} —obtained from a real Ax/BoTorch run on synthetic objective values. To be regenerated from campaign data.

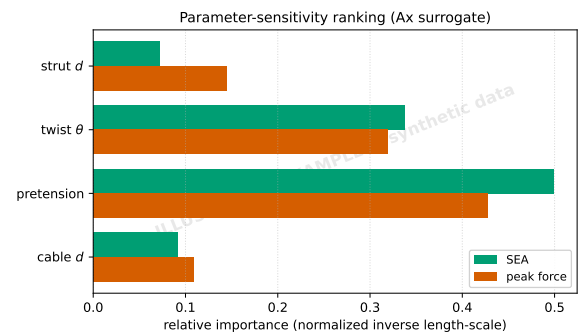


Fig. 6 Illustrative example (synthetic data). Parameter-sensitivity ranking (model length-scale-based importances per objective; cf. SAASBO inverse length-scales or Sobol indices) of the design variables in Table 1, from the same Ax/BoTorch run as Fig. 5.

349 Pending TODOs and figure/table placeholders

350 Tighten abstract to 150–200 words with concrete numerical results once the experimental campaign is complete. 1

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Author order / contributions (per @me-madsen). 352

Planned order: Marcus E. Madsen*, Audrey K. Christiansen*, Jinkwan Han*, Jeffrey R. Hill^{†‡}, Sterling G. Baird^{†‡}, where * = equal contribution, † = also equal contribution, and ‡ = corresponding author. 353

Confirm affiliations and add emails for M. Madsen, A. Christiansen, and J. Han, and typeset the equal-contribution footnote per ASME JMD style. 1 354

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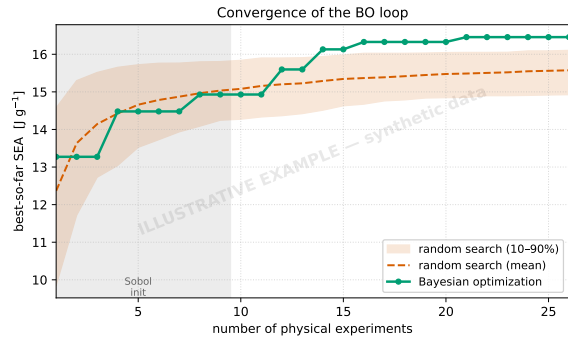


Fig. 7 Illustrative example (synthetic data). Best-so-far SEA vs. number of physical experiments for the Ax/BoTorch loop against an independent random-search baseline; the shaded region is the $n = 9$ Sobol initialization. Generated on synthetic objective values; to be replaced with campaign results (with confidence intervals over random seeds, and Pareto hypervolume for the multi-objective runs).

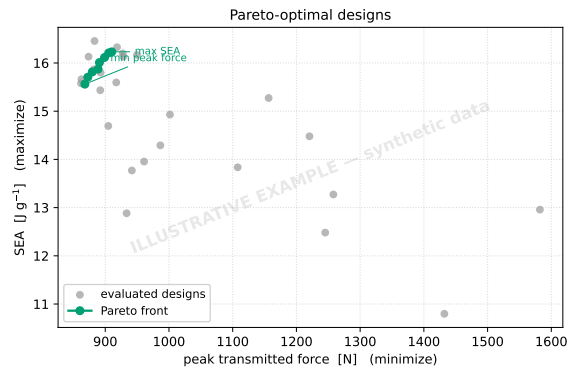


Fig. 8 Illustrative example (synthetic data). Pareto front in (peak transmitted force, SEA) space with all evaluated designs, from the Ax/BoTorch loop on synthetic objective values; representative geometries to be annotated once campaign data are available.

Manuscript status. At time of writing the project is at the *planned-methods* phase: the parameterized unit cell, multi-material print recipe, joint geometry, quasi-static and drop-impact protocols, and Bayesian-optimization loop described in Section 3 have been scaffolded and prototype hardware has been printed, but the closed-loop experimental campaign has not yet produced reportable results. Sections 4 and 5 therefore remain placeholders.

Add 1–2 sentences clearly stating the gap this paper closes vs. Pajunen et al. [11] (single fabrication condition, no closed-loop optimization) and Mo et al. [17] (multifidelity BO, but simulation-only).

We need to decide whether or not to mention/include the physics-based simulations from PR #33, which seem quite reasonable at this point. If the goal is to get the best of the best, then we would want to include those simulations. In that case we would likely want to treat this as a multi-task problem, but we could run into issues with scaling. If we treat it as a featurization task, then we would likely need to move to a predefined search space or a genetic algorithm.

Eventually switch this overview figure to a vertical orientation; it is currently reproduced from the MRG proposal (figures/overview-updated.png).

Consider a figure that places our approach against this prior work (e.g., a 2-D map of fabrication route vs. optimization strategy, or representative prior-art unit cells) to sharpen the differentiation, per review.

Consider adding genuinely tensegrity-inspired 3D-printed references to strengthen this background (Edison T4): Bauer et al. 2021 (*Adv. Mater.*, doi:10.1002/adma.202005647); Pajunen et al. 2021 (*Extreme Mech. Lett.*, doi:10.1016/j.eml.2021.101236); Santos 2023 (*Adv. Mater.*, doi:10.1002/adma.202300639); Sabouni-Zawadzka et al. 2024 (doi:10.24425/ace.2024.150987); and verify-then-cite Almeida et al. 2025 (doi:10.1016/j.ijsolstr.2025.113590), Davami et al. 2025 (doi:10.1016/j.ijimpeng.2024.105208), and Wang et al. 2026 (doi:10.1016/j.addma.2026.105107).

Add a short paragraph on relevant TPU/PETG tensegrity search-space bounds once the Edison literature task 5ae24eaf-5b6e-45cf-9f6c-1c7fbd881738 synthesis is integrated.

Specify exact lower/upper bounds, manufacturing-feasibility constraints, and the categorical-encoding scheme used by the BO loop. Pull from the Edison TPU/PETG search-space synthesis once available.

strut diameter

Cite the heterogeneous-parameters Edison LITERATURE_HIGH brief (5191cf4d) on D3-symmetric vs. fully-per-member parameterization.

The cable-diameter lower bound (3.0 mm) is set by the Bambu auto-support detection floor; reconcile this continuous range with the FFF-resolvable categorical set {1.2, 1.8, 2.4, 3.0, 4.5} mm stated above for the working prototype, and add manufacturing-feasibility constraints and the categorical-encoding scheme for the connectivity-topology variable.

Quantitatively verify the internal-anchoring junction strength against the PR #39 / PR #35 joint pull-out studies before making any cyclic-durability claim.

Document slicer profile (layer height, infill, print speed, nozzle temperatures, retraction settings) and validation prints used to characterize PLA-TPU interface strength.

Cite the joint-design Phase-3 CAD review (Edison ANALYSIS 19e0c868) and the Phase-4 vision review (e9a1f4cc) once both are integrated into the references.

@achris0520 to confirm the exact PLA and TPU print parameters (nozzle and bed temperatures, layer height, print speeds, infill) used on the Bambu Lab H2D; only the build-plate type, vertical orientation, and support strategy are currently established.

Cite the Instron-stiffness Edison LITERATURE_HIGH brief (9f68e71e) once the entry is added to references.bib.

Cite the canonical cellular-absorber references for these definitions once added to the bib (Edison T26): Gibson & Ashby; Avalor, Belingardi & Montanini 2001; Tan et al. 2005; Michailidis et al. 2011.

Cite the drop-test protocol document (PR #67) and the drop-test Edison LITERATURE_HIGH brief (653d7d39) once integrated.

Cite the M23 + QTec equipment brief (Edison LITERATURE_HIGH 1a0f4a70) once integrated.

Cite the per-modality objective-function briefs (Edison LITERATURE_HIGH cfd30f3e, 7d6b43bf, 31126ee7, 9d74ab2e, f40e41a7) and the ANALYSIS synthesis (789de8ab) once references.bib entries are added from PR #60.

452	Specify the exact test fixtures, load-cell ranges, sampling rate, DAQ, drop heights, and the protocol for averaging replicate prints.	4	[8] Sabelhaus, A. P., Bruce, J., Caluwaerts, K., Manovi, P., Firoozi, R. F., Dobi, S., Agogino, A. M., and SunSpiral, V., 2015, "System Design and Locomotion of SUPERball, an Untethered Tensegrity Robot," <i>2015 IEEE International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA)</i> , pp. 2867–2873, doi: 10.1109/ICRA.2015.7139590.	521
453				522
454				523
455	Add: kernel choice (e.g. Matérn-5/2), input warping, normalization, batch size q , total budget T , initialization strategy (LHS or Sobol), and seed protocol. . . .	4	[9] Vespignani, M., Friesen, J. M., SunSpiral, V., and Bruce, J., 2018, "Design of SUPERball v2, a Compliant Tensegrity Robot for Absorbing Large Impacts," , pp. 2865–2871.	524
456				525
457				526
458	Cite the BO scaffolding (PR #30), the T3-prism Sobol batch (PR #35), and the heterogeneous-parameter Edison brief (5191cf4d) once those branches land in main. . . .	4	[10] Deitrich, N., Baldonado, K. M., Khan, A., Cook, J., and Rizzo, L., 2022, "A Rideshare Tensegrity Rover Concept to Explore Titan's Lands and Oceans," <i>AIAA SciTech Forum</i> , NASA Langley Research Center / Ames Research Center.	527
459				528
460				529
461	The previous BO-loop schematic here was redundant with the overview figure (Fig. 1); per review it is replaced with surrogate-diagnostic figures. Figs. 5–8 are currently <i>illustrative examples</i> produced by a real Ax/BoTorch loop on synthetic objective values (scripts/figures/ax_placeholder_figures_example.py); replace the synthetic evaluate() with measured outcomes once the campaign runs.	4	[11] Pajunen, K., Johanns, P., Pal, R. K., Rimoli, J. J., and Daraio, C., 2019, "Design and Impact Response of 3D-Printable Tensegrity-Inspired Structures," <i>Materials & Design</i> , 182 , p. 107966.	530
462				531
463				532
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466				535
467				536
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469	Populate Results section once the experimental campaign produces data. Suggested subsections follow.	4	[12] Ye, H., Liu, Q., Cheng, J., Li, H., Jian, B., Wang, R., Sun, Z., Lu, Y., and Ge, Q., 2023, "Multimaterial 3D Printed Self-Locking Thick-Panel Origami Metamaterials," <i>Nature Communications</i> , 14 , p. 1607.	538
470				539
471				540
472	Plot best-so-far performance vs. number of physical experiments for each acquisition function, with confidence intervals over random seeds.	4	[13] Khatri, N. R. and Egan, P. F., 2024, "Energy Absorption of 3D Printed ABS and TPU Multimaterial Honeycomb Structures," <i>3D Printing and Additive Manufacturing</i> , 11 , pp. e840–e850.	541
473				542
474				543
475	Show 3–5 representative geometries from along the Pareto front trading SEA against peak transmitted force.	4	[14] Silver, D., Huang, A., Maddison, C. J., Guez, A., Sifre, L., van den Driessche, G., Schrittwieser, J., Antonoglou, I., Panneershelvam, V., Lanctot, M., et al., 2016, "Mastering the Game of Go with Deep Neural Networks and Tree Search," <i>Nature</i> , 529 (7587), pp. 484–489.	544
476				545
477	Report between-print variability (CV) for top-ranked designs; informs the choice of input-noise-robust acquisition.	4	[15] Ament, S., Witte, A., Garg, N., and Kusuma, J., 2023, "Sustainable Concrete via Bayesian Optimization," <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:2310.18288</i> , NeurIPS 2023 Workshop on Adaptive Experimental Design and Active Learning in the Real World.	546
478				547
479	Table repeatability: Mean and CV of SEA, peak force, and compaction efficiency across n replicate prints for the top- k designs.	4	[16] Strieth-Kalthoff, F., Hao, H., Rathore, V., Derasp, J., Gaudin, T., Angello, N. H., Seifrid, M., Trushina, E., Guy, M., Liu, J., et al., 2024, "Delocalized, Asynchronous, Closed-Loop Discovery of Organic Laser Emitters," <i>Science</i> , 384 (6697), p. eadk9227.	548
480				549
481				550
482	Populate Discussion section once Results are in. Anchor against the gaps identified in Section 1 and the prior work cited in Section 2.	5	[17] Mo, C., Perdikaris, P., and Raney, J. R., 2023, "Accelerated Design of Architected Materials with Multifidelity Bayesian Optimization," <i>Journal of Engineering Mechanics</i> , 149 (6), p. 04023028.	551
483				552
484				553
485	19–25 mm	5	[18] Wang, Y. et al., 2022, "Bayesian Optimization for the Design of Mechanical Metamaterials," <i>Journal of the Mechanics and Physics of Solids</i> , 159 , p. 104734.	554
486				555
487	Identify limitations: design space size relative to experimental budget; reliance on a single fabrication platform; metric selection (axial impact only).	5	[19] Lee, S. et al., 2023, "Bayesian Optimization for Structural Design Problems," <i>Structural and Multidisciplinary Optimization</i> , 66 (2), p. 47.	556
488				557
489	Two-sentence quantitative summary of the headline outcome (e.g., improvement in SEA over baselines within N rounds; identification of a Pareto-optimal geometry validated by replicate prints).	5	[20] Zhang, M., Parnell, A., Brabazon, A., and Benavoli, A., 2021, "Bayesian Optimisation for Sequential Experimental Design with Applications in Additive Manufacturing," <i>arXiv preprint arXiv:2107.12809</i> .	558
490				559
491				560
492				561
493	Confirm exact grant numbers and acknowledge any NASA/Utah-Space-Grant-Consortium support per acknowledgment-text guidelines.	5	[21] Balandat, M., Karrer, B., Jiang, D. R., Daulton, S., Letham, B., Wilson, A. G., and Bakshy, E., 2020, "BoTorch: A Framework for Efficient Monte-Carlo Bayesian Optimization," <i>Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems 33 (NeurIPS 2020)</i> , https://arxiv.org/abs/1910.06403	562
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496	award number	5	[22] Olson, M., Santorella, E., Tiao, L. C., Cakmak, S., Garrard, M., Daulton, S., Lin, Z. J., Ament, S., Beckerman, B., Onofrey, E., Igusti, P., Lara, C., Letham, B., Cardoso, C., Shen, S. S., Lin, A. C., Grange, M., Kashatelyan, E., Eriksson, D., Balandat, M., and Bakshy, E., 2025, "Ax: A Platform for Adaptive Experimentation," <i>Proceedings of the Fourth International Conference on Automated Machine Learning</i> , L. Akoglu, C. Doerr, J. N. van Rijn, R. Garnett, and J. R. Gardner, eds., Proceedings of Machine Learning Research, Vol. 293, PMLR, pp. 21/1–25, https://proceedings.mlr.press/v293/olson25a.html	565
497				566
498	Add Utah NASA Space Grant Consortium award if applicable.	5	[23] Santos, F. A., 2023, "Toward a novel energy-dissipation metamaterial with tensegrity architecture," <i>Advanced Materials</i> , May 2023.	567
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List of Figures

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